

HP Color LaserJet 3700dn

Connected Colour of Laser

The 3700dn is slower compared to the other low-end models. It took 31 seconds to print a text page, which is twice the time taken by the HP 1500. It also printed the test image slowly, taking 34 seconds. This means that if someone fires a test image, others who have fired simple documents will have to wait in queue for a long time. Again, image quality was not up to the mark. The first print was very dark, and in an attempt to get a better idea of the print quality, we printed multiple images to warm up the printer and then evaluate the copies. The rest of the prints were better than the first one, and comparable to those offered by the LaserJet 1500, but nowhere near the quality offered by an average inkjet printer.

This network colour laser printer has an unconventional cartridge assembly. The CMY and K toner cartridges are placed one above the other rather, than in a circular fashion. This makes the printing process faster, since the printer saves on the roll time of four toner cartridges. HP claims that the printer prints both mono and colour pages at 16 ppm.

The printer works over the USB 1.1 interface, and has a built-in network card. The 3700dn also has a built-in Web server, using which the administrator can access the printer over the network and troubleshoot and monitor it. A test page



provides the necessary information such as the IP address and DNS server, necessary to access the printer. The Web server can be accessed through a browser that has three tabs—Information, Setting and Networking. The page displays information such as toner cartridge levels, paper level in trays 1 and 2 and so on. The printer supports TCP/IP, IPX/SX, AppleTalk, Netware and Unix/Linux (RedHat and SuSe) networks, which means that most OSes, if not all, in use today in big organisations are covered.

The printer has two paper-handling trays, and if needed, you can use the optional third tray. The first tray can hold 100 sheets, whereas the second, 250. The printer is capable of automatic two-sided printing, which means that you can get 700 prints at one go.

All in all, the 3700dn is a good solution for organisations where print documents are primarily text, with images only occasionally.

+ Network-ready; easy configuration of the network possible via the built-in Web server; toner and paper levels visible via a Web browser; two paper trays with a third optional tray
- Image quality not up to the mark
Price: Rs. 97,999 + taxes

HP Color LaserJet 3700dn		B+
Performance	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	
Features	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	
Value for money	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	



Buying tips

- Initial price and the price of consumables are the most important factors to consider before investing in a laser printer. Buy a laser printer only if volume, speed and quality are all important. Also check the price and availability of toner cartridges
- Go for a printer that is network-ready, or, at the least, has a slot for a

- network card. Also, find out if wireless networking is possible
- Find one that offers a memory upgrade option. This will help with larger print loads, once more users are added to the existing pool
- See if you can find a printer that can take an optional paper tray—you can purchase a paper tray if and when

- needed. Add-on paper trays increase paper capacity by 250 or so
- If there's going to be a lot of volume printing, look for USB 1.1/2.0. It's faster than the parallel interface
- You need an on-site warranty. If you don't get one, and the printer stopped working, you'd have to lug 25 Kg of equipment to a service centre

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